APPENDIX 3

Matcher Cheat Sheet

In *Matchers Included in RSpec Expectations*, we went through the most commonly used matchers included in RSpec. Now, we'd like to show you all the matchers built-in to RSpec as of version 3.6 in a single reference that you can keep handy while you're writing specs.

The *Passes if...* column provides an expression for each matcher that's equivalent to what the matcher checks. The snippet isn't necessarily how the matcher is implemented internally, as we've glossed over a few edge cases that don't arise during daily use. If you're curious about these implementation details, you can check out the source code.[1]

Value Matchers

Given any Ruby expression `a`, value matchers are expressed in the form:

```
expect(a).to matcher
```

To negate a matcher, use either `not_to` or `to_not` rather than `to`:

```
expect(a).not_to matcher
# or
expect(a).to_not matcher
```

Equality/Identity

Matcher	Passes if...	Available aliases
eq(x)	a == x	an_object_eq_to(x)
eql(x)	a.eql?(x)	an_object_eql_to(x)
equal(x)	a.equal?(x)	be(x) an_object_equal_to(x)

1. https://github.com/rspec/rspec-expectations